

41.55/55

PHYS405 - Fall 2024 - Final Exam

Multiple Choice - 2 points each unless otherwise indicated - circle your answer clearly. If you provide an explanation, the explanation may be used to assign partial credit if the answer you chose is incorrect.

1.) (2 pts) This question consists of several true/false questions (0.5 pts each) about the angular momentum of a quantum system. Circle whether each one is True or False.

- ☒ T ☒ T / F For a system with a known angular momentum $|\vec{L}| \neq 0$, the maximum measurable value of L_z is less than $|\vec{L}|$
☒ T ☒ T / F It is possible to know both the z component of the angular momentum and the total angular momentum at the same time.
☒ F ☒ T / ☒ F If $|\vec{L}| \neq 0$, it is possible to know both the x and y components of the angular momentum at the same time
☒ T ☒ F For a hydrogen atom, it is possible to know both the atom's energy and its total angular momentum at the same time.

2.) We used the technique of separation of variables many times during this course. In one example we were separating the radial dependence of the wave function from the angular dependence with the guess $\psi(r, \theta, \phi) = R(r)Y(\theta, \phi)$. We then derived

$$\frac{1}{R(r)} \frac{d}{dr} (r^2 R'(r)) - \frac{2mr^2}{\hbar^2} [V(r) - E] = \frac{-1}{Y} \left[\frac{1}{\sin \theta} \frac{\partial}{\partial \theta} \left(\sin \theta \frac{\partial Y}{\partial \theta} \right) + \frac{1}{\sin^2 \theta} \frac{\partial^2 Y}{\partial \phi^2} \right] \quad (1)$$

We concluded that

- ☒ (a) Both sides of this equation must be zero
☒ (b) Both sides of this equation must be equal to the same constant which we called $\ell(\ell + 1)$.
☒ (c) The guess must be wrong because a function of r cannot be equal to a function of θ and ϕ .
☒ (d) The left side of this equation is equal to a constant which we called m and the right side of this equation is equal to a constant which we called $\ell(\ell + 1)$
☒ (e) The left side of this equation is equal to zero and the right side of this equation is equal to a constant which we called $\ell(\ell + 1)$

- 3.) Using the canonical commutation relations for position and momentum, and the fact that $\hat{L}_z = \hat{x}\hat{p}_y - \hat{y}\hat{p}_x$, determine the following commutator:

$$[\hat{L}_z, \hat{x}] = ? \quad \text{work not so clear...} \quad (2)$$

- (a) $i\hbar\hat{y}$
 (b) $-i\hbar\hat{x}$
 (c) 0
 (d) $-i\hbar\hat{p}_x$
 (e) $-i\hbar\hat{p}_y$

$$(\hat{x}\hat{p}_y - \hat{y}\hat{p}_x)\hat{x} - \hat{x}(\hat{x}\hat{p}_y - \hat{y}\hat{p}_x)$$

$$\cancel{\hat{x}\hat{p}_y\hat{x}} - \hat{y}\hat{p}_x\hat{x} - \cancel{\hat{x}^2\hat{p}_y} + \hat{x}\hat{y}\hat{p}_x$$

$$\hat{x}\hat{p}_y\hat{x} - \hat{y}\hat{p}_x\hat{x} - \hat{x}\hat{p}_y\hat{x} + \hat{x}\hat{y}\hat{p}_x$$

$$-\hat{y}\hat{p}_x\hat{x} + \hat{x}\hat{y}\hat{p}_x$$

$$[\hat{p}_x, \hat{x}] = -i\hbar$$

$$\hat{x}[\hat{p}_y, \hat{x}] = 0$$

$$\hat{y}\hat{p}_x = 0$$

$$\hat{x}\hat{y}\hat{p}_x \xrightarrow{\text{comm}} \hat{y}\hat{x}\hat{p}_x = i\hbar\hat{y}$$

- 4.) Consider two observables A and B and their associated operators $\hat{A}$ and $\hat{B}$. In your lab, you perform the following experiment hundreds of times:

A particle is prepared in the state ψ_1 (this is the same for all trials), you then make a single measurement of either A or B . The results of the experiment are as follows:

- Whenever A is measured, you always get the same value a_1
- Whenever B is measured, sometimes you get value b_1 and sometimes you get value b_2 .

Are the following statements true or false? Circle your answer: (0.5 point each)

- ☒ TRUE / ☒ FALSE ψ_1 is an eigenfunction of $\hat{A}$
☒ TRUE / ☒ FALSE ψ_1 is an eigenfunction of $\hat{B}$
☒ TRUE / ☒ FALSE The operators $\hat{A}$ and $\hat{B}$ commute with each other
☒ TRUE / ☒ FALSE You cannot know both observables A and B at the same time.

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- 5.) For an electron in a hydrogen atom, how many different energy eigenfunctions have energy $E_4 = -13.6\text{eV}/4^2 = -0.85\text{eV}$? In other words, what is the degeneracy of the $n = 4$ energy level for hydrogen?

- (a) 1
(b) 2
(c) 4
(d) 9
(e) 16

$$E_4 = \frac{-13.6\text{eV}}{4^2} = -0.85\text{eV}$$

$$\begin{aligned} 400 \\ 41-1 \\ 42-2 \\ 43-3 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} 0 \leq l \leq n-1 \\ -l \leq m \leq +l \end{aligned}$$

$$n l m \quad n=4$$

- 6.) (4 pts) For each statement, mark whether it correctly applies to the one-dimensional infinite square well (ISW), the one-dimensional quantum harmonic oscillator (QHO), the hydrogen atom, or none of the above? Place a checkmark in the appropriate boxes. Note that it is possible for a statement to apply to more than one system.

Statement	ISW	QHO	Hydrogen	None of these
Ground state is labeled by $n = 1$	☒	☒	☒	
Ground state energy is $E = 0$	☒	☒		☒
Energy levels are equally spaced		☒		
Energy eigenfunctions use Laguerre polynomials			☒	

7.8

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Free Response Questions - Show all steps of your solution to receive credit. You may use the formulas and integrals on the attached formula sheet without proving them.

- 1.) (10 pts) A quantum particle of mass M experiences a harmonic oscillator potential $V(x) = \frac{1}{2}M\omega^2 x^2$. At time $t = 0$, the particle is in an equal superposition of ground state and first excited state. In other words, at time $t = 0$ if you measured the energy of the particle, you would have a (2/3) probability of getting the ground state energy and a (1/3) probability of getting the first excited state energy.

$\xi = \sqrt{\frac{m\omega}{\hbar}} x$
 $\alpha = \left(\frac{m\omega}{\pi\hbar}\right)^{1/4}$
 $\frac{3}{4}$

- (a) (4 pts) Write out the normalized initial wave function $\Psi(\xi, 0)$ using the dimensionless variable ξ instead of x . Your expression should be in terms of ξ , M , ω , and fundamental constants. If you use any other symbols, make sure they are defined clearly. It is ok to assume $\Psi(\xi, 0)$ is real and positive for all ξ .

- (b) (4 pts) What is the wave function at a later time $\Psi(\xi, t)$? Your expression in terms of ξ , M , ω , t and fundamental constants. If you use any other symbols, make sure they are defined clearly.

- (c) (2 pts) Does the probability density for this particle depend on time, or not? You can either explain your answer in words, or do a short calculation to justify your answer.

$\Psi_n(x) = \frac{\alpha}{\sqrt{2^n n!}} H_n(\xi) e^{-\xi^2/2}$ $\Psi_0 = \frac{\alpha}{1} (1) e^{-\xi^2/2}$ $\frac{2}{3} \alpha e^{-\xi^2/2}$

$\Psi_1 = \frac{\alpha}{\sqrt{2}} 2\xi e^{-\xi^2/2}$ $\frac{1}{3} \frac{2\alpha}{\sqrt{2}} \xi e^{-\xi^2/2}$

$1 = \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} A^2 \Psi^* \Psi dx = A^2 \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} \left(\frac{2}{3} \alpha e^{-\xi^2/2} + \frac{1}{3} \frac{2\alpha}{\sqrt{2}} \xi e^{-\xi^2/2} \right)^2 d\xi$

Forgot $|c_n|^2 = P(E_n)$ (-0.5)

$= A^2 \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} \left(\left(\frac{2}{3}\right)^2 \alpha^2 e^{-\xi^2} + \left(\frac{1}{3}\right)^2 \left(\frac{2\alpha}{\sqrt{2}}\right)^2 \xi^2 e^{-\xi^2} + \frac{2}{9} \frac{2\alpha^2}{\sqrt{2}} \xi e^{-\xi^2} \right) d\xi$

$= A^2 \alpha^2 \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} \left(\frac{4}{9} e^{-\xi^2} + \frac{2}{9} \xi^2 e^{-\xi^2} + \frac{8}{9\sqrt{2}} \xi e^{-\xi^2} \right) d\xi$ $u = \xi^2 \quad du = 2\xi d\xi = \sqrt{u}$

$= A^2 \alpha^2 \left[\frac{4}{9} \sqrt{\pi} + \frac{1}{9} \sqrt{\pi} \right]$ odd w/ symm bounds

$1 = \frac{A^2}{9} \sqrt{\frac{m\omega}{\pi\hbar}} (4\sqrt{\pi} + \sqrt{\pi})$

$9 = A^2 \sqrt{\frac{m\omega}{\hbar}} (5)$

$\sqrt{\frac{9}{5}} \sqrt{\frac{\hbar}{m\omega}} = A$

$A = \left(\frac{9\sqrt{\hbar}}{5\sqrt{m\omega}} \right)^{1/2}$ (1)

? Asked for the initial wave function (-0.5)

$\Psi_n(\xi)$ are already normalized so determining A is not needed.

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b.) $\Psi(x, t)$ $A = \left(\frac{9}{5} \sqrt{\frac{\hbar}{m\omega}}\right)^{1/2}$ $A \propto \sqrt{\frac{9}{5}} \left(\frac{\hbar}{m\omega}\right)^{1/4} \left(\frac{m\omega}{\hbar}\right)^{1/4}$

$\Psi(x, t) = A \left(\frac{2}{3} \Psi_0 + \frac{1}{3} \Psi_1 \right) e^{-iE_n t/\hbar}$ $E_n = (n + 1/2) \hbar \omega = \sqrt{\frac{9}{5}} \pi^{-1/4}$

$E_0 = \frac{\hbar \omega}{2}$ $E_1 = \frac{3\hbar \omega}{2}$

$$\Psi(x, t) = \sqrt{\frac{9}{5} \pi}^{-1/4} \left[\frac{2}{3} e^{-\frac{1}{2}(\xi^2 + i\omega t)} + \frac{1}{3} \xi e^{-\frac{1}{2}(\xi^2 + 3i\omega t)} \right]$$

b.) where $\xi = \sqrt{\frac{m\omega}{\hbar}} x$

c.) NO, ⁽⁻¹⁾ Since the Probability Distribution is the Product of the complex conjugate & the original terms with "i" disappear. Furthermore the cross terms are zero due to orthonormality (and odd integrand w/symm bounds).

This is only when integrated.

-0.2

6.8

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2.) (7 pts) An electron is in an infinite square well of length L . Initially, the electron's normalized wave function is:

$$\Psi(x, 0) = \begin{cases} \sqrt{\frac{30}{L}} \left(\frac{x}{L}\right) \left(1 - \frac{x}{L}\right) & 0 \leq x \leq L \\ 0 & x < 0 \text{ or } x > L \end{cases} \rightarrow \sqrt{\frac{30}{L}} \left(\frac{x}{L} - \frac{x^2}{L^2}\right) \quad (3)$$

1.8 (a) (2 pts) What is $\hat{H}\Psi(x, 0)$? [Recall $\hat{H} = \hat{p}^2/2M + V(\hat{x})$].

1 (b) (1 pt) Is $\Psi(x, 0)$ an eigenfunction of $\hat{H}$? Explain why or why not.

4 (c) (4 pts) Determine $\langle p \rangle$ for this wave function (at $t = 0$). Justify your answer with an explicit calculation.

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{H}\Psi(x, 0) &= E\Psi \\ &= \frac{-\hbar^2}{2M} \frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2} \left(\Psi + V(x)\Psi \right) \\ &= \frac{-\hbar^2}{2M} \frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2} \left(\sqrt{\frac{30}{L}} \left(\frac{x}{L} - \frac{x^2}{L^2} \right) \right) \\ &= \frac{-\hbar^2}{2M} \left(\sqrt{\frac{30}{L}} \cdot \frac{-2}{L^2} \right) \end{aligned}$$

(a) $\hat{H}\Psi(x, 0) = \frac{\hbar^2}{M} \sqrt{\frac{30}{L}} \cdot \frac{1}{L^2} = \frac{\hbar^2}{M} \sqrt{\frac{30}{L}} \cdot \frac{1}{L^2}$

$\frac{1}{2} \quad -0.2$

b.) No, since when $\hat{H}$ is applied to Ψ , it doesn't return a number (eigenvalue) times Ψ , so it is by definition not an eigenfunction.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{c.) } \langle p \rangle &= \int_0^L \Psi^* \hat{p} \Psi dx \\ &= \int_0^L \sqrt{\frac{30}{L}} \cdot (-i\hbar) \cdot \left(\frac{x}{L} - \frac{x^2}{L^2} \right) \left(\frac{1}{L} - \frac{2x}{L^2} \right) dx \\ &= \frac{-30i\hbar}{L} \left[\frac{x^2}{2L^2} + \frac{x^4}{2L^4} - \frac{x^3}{L^3} \right]_0^L = \frac{-30i\hbar}{L} \left(\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2} - 1 \right) = 0 \quad \text{Wow!} \end{aligned}$$

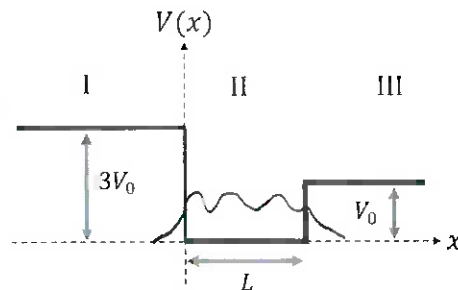
There is no preference to move either direction in ISL

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- 3.) (9 pts) A quantum particle of mass M moves in the potential shown. The potential $V(x < 0) = 3V_0$ and $V(x > L) = V_0$. The particle is in the lowest energy state with $E < V_0$, this is a bound state.



$$E < V_0 \Rightarrow (E - V_0)$$

negative

The wave function in region II is

$$\psi_{II}(x) = C \cos(kx) + D \sin(kx) \quad (4)$$

where $k = \sqrt{2ME/\hbar^2}$

- 2.5 (a) (3 pts) What is the general form of the wave function in region I that solves the time-independent Schrödinger equation? Impose the requirement that the wave function must be normalizable (but you do NOT have to normalize it). Your expression should be in terms of E , M , $\hbar$, V_0 , x , and one arbitrary constant, which we'll call A .

- 2 (b) (3 pts) What is the general form of the wave function in region III that solves the time-independent Schrödinger equation? Impose the requirement that the wave function must be normalizable (but you do NOT have to normalize it). Your expression should be in terms of E , M , $\hbar$, V_0 , x , and one arbitrary constant, which we'll call F .

- 2.5 (c) (3 pts) By imposing appropriate boundary conditions at $x = 0$, determine C and D in terms of A , V_0 , and E .

a.) $-\frac{\hbar^2}{2M} \nabla^2 \psi_I + V(\psi_I) = i\hbar \psi_I$ this is negative

$$\psi_I'' = \frac{2M(E - 3V_0)}{\hbar^2} \psi_I \rightarrow -\sqrt{\frac{2M(3V_0 - E)}{\hbar^2}} \psi_I$$

$$\Rightarrow \psi_I = A e^{-\beta x} + B e^{\beta x}$$

unphysical $\rightarrow$

$$\beta = \sqrt{\frac{2M(3V_0 - E)}{\hbar^2}} \quad \psi_I(x) = A e^{-\beta x} \quad (a)$$

$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2M} \nabla^2 \psi_{III} + V \psi_{III} = i\hbar \psi_{III}$$

$$\psi_{III}'' = \frac{2M(E - V_0)}{\hbar^2} \psi_{III} \rightarrow -\sqrt{\frac{2M(V_0 - E)}{\hbar^2}} \psi_{III}$$

$$\psi_{III} = F e^{i\gamma x} + G e^{-i\gamma x}$$

unphysical $\rightarrow$

$$\gamma = \sqrt{\frac{2M(V_0 - E)}{\hbar^2}} \quad \psi_{III} = G e^{-i\gamma x} \quad (b)$$

-1
Exponent shouldn't be imaginary

-0.5
Should the signs differ?

$$\begin{aligned} x \rightarrow 0 & \quad \psi_I = 1 \\ x \rightarrow -\infty & \quad \psi_I \rightarrow 0 \end{aligned}$$



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$$\psi_{II} = C \cos Kx + D \sin Kx$$

$$\psi_I = A e^{iBx}$$

$$A = C$$

-0.3

$$\psi_I(0) = \psi_{II}(0)$$

$$\psi'_I(0) = \psi'_{II}(0)$$

$$C + D = A$$

$$KD = iBA$$

$$C \cos(0) + D \sin(0) = A$$

$$D = \frac{-iBA}{K}$$

$$-K C \sin(K \cdot 0) - KD \cos(K \cdot 0) = iBA$$

$$C - \frac{iBA}{K} = A$$

$$KD = iBA$$

$$C = A \left(1 + \frac{iB}{K} \right)$$

$$D = \frac{iBA}{K}$$

$$D = \frac{-iBA}{K}$$

$$B = \sqrt{\frac{2m(3V_0 - E)}{\hbar^2}}$$

$$K = \sqrt{\frac{2mE}{\hbar^2}}$$

$$\frac{B}{K} = \frac{3V_0 - E}{E}$$

$$\begin{aligned} D &= \frac{i(3V_0 - E)}{E} A \\ C &= \left(1 + \frac{i(3V_0 - E)}{E} \right) A \end{aligned}$$

lost sign
-0.2

4.) (9 pts) A hydrogen atom is described by the wave function at time $t = 0$

$$\Psi(\vec{r}, 0) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{96\pi a^3}} \left(\frac{r}{a}\right) e^{-r/2a} \quad (5)$$

which is NOT an energy eigenfunction. Here a denotes the Bohr radius.

3.7 (a) (4 pts) Show that the state $\Psi(\vec{r}, 0)$ is normalized.

2.5 (b) (5 pts) If, at time $t = 0$, someone measures the energy of this atom, what is the probability that they will receive a value of -13.6eV ?

$$1 = \iiint \Psi^* \Psi dR$$

$$4! = 4 \cdot 3 \cdot 2 \cdot 1 = 24$$

$$1 = \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^\pi \int_0^\infty \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{96\pi a^3}} \left(\frac{r}{a}\right) e^{-r/2a} \right)^2 r^2 \sin\theta dr d\theta d\phi$$

$$1 = \frac{1}{96\pi a^3} \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^\pi \int_0^\infty \frac{r^2}{a^2} e^{-r/2a} r^2 \sin\theta dr d\theta d\phi$$

$$1 = \frac{1}{96\pi a^3} \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^\pi \int_0^\infty u^4 \frac{16}{a^4} e^{-u} \frac{1}{2a} \sin\theta du d\theta d\phi$$

$$1 = \frac{1}{224\pi a^2} \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^\pi \int_0^\infty u^4 e^{-u} \sin\theta du d\theta d\phi$$

$$= \frac{1}{4\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^\pi \sin\theta d\theta d\phi = \frac{1}{4\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} [-\cos\theta]_0^\pi d\phi$$

$$= \frac{1}{2\pi} (2\pi - 0) = 1 \quad \checkmark$$

$$u = r/2a$$

$$du = \frac{1}{2a} dr$$

$$r = 2au$$

$$dr = 2a du$$

$$r^4 = 16a^4 u^4$$

$$u^4 = \frac{r^4}{16a^4}$$

$$(-1-1) = -(2)-1 = -2$$

$$\Psi(\vec{r}, 0) = \text{[Intentionally Blank]}$$

$$\checkmark \psi_{100} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{\pi}a^3} e^{-r/a}$$

$$R_{nl}(r) = A_{nl} e^{-r/na} \left(\frac{2r}{na}\right)^l L_{n-l-1}^{2l+1}\left(\frac{2r}{na}\right) \quad n=2$$

$l=0?$

$$\psi_{200} = \tilde{A} e^{-r/2a} \cdot 1_0 = \tilde{A} \frac{1}{\sqrt{4\pi}} e^{-r/2a} \left(\frac{r}{a}\right) \tilde{A} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{24}a^3} \quad \frac{96}{4} = \frac{166}{4} = 24$$

$$\frac{1}{\sqrt{24}a^3} \frac{1}{\sqrt{4\pi}} e^{-r/2a}$$

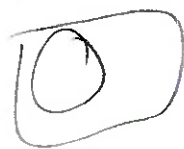
$$P(E_n) = \left(\frac{1}{24a^3}\right) (-13.6 \text{ eV})$$

$$|c_{nl}|^2 E_n$$

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this is $n=2$ $E(\psi_1) = -13.6 \text{ eV}$

It isn't
an energy
eigenstate.



$$\frac{-13.6 \text{ eV}}{2^2}$$

$$= -13.6 \text{ eV}$$

$$c_{100} = \int \Psi(x, 0) \psi_{100} d^3r$$

$$P = |c_{100}|^2$$

3.2

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5.) (6 pts) Consider the following wave function describing an electron in a hydrogen atom

$$\Psi = \frac{1}{2} \psi_{3,1,0} + \frac{i}{\sqrt{2}} \psi_{2,1,1} - \frac{1}{2} \psi_{3,2,0} \quad (6)$$

where we're using the usual notation $\psi_{n,\ell,m}$ to denote the energy eigenfunctions for hydrogen.

1.6 (a) (3 pts) What is the expectation value of the z-component of the angular momentum $\langle L_z \rangle$ for a particle described by this wave function?

1.6 (b) (3 pts) What is the expectation value of the total angular momentum squared $\langle \vec{L}^2 \rangle$ for a particle described by this wave function?

$$\begin{aligned} L_z Y_\ell^m &= m\hbar Y_\ell^m \\ \frac{\hbar}{\sqrt{2}} \psi_{2,1} & \quad 2\hbar \end{aligned} \quad \begin{aligned} Y_1^0 &= 1-z \quad \leftarrow m=0 \\ Y_1^1 &= z-z^2 \quad \leftarrow m=1 \\ Y_2^0 &= \frac{1}{2} z^2 - z + 1 \quad \leftarrow m=0 \end{aligned}$$

$$\langle L_z \rangle = \langle \psi_{2,1} | L_z | \psi_{2,1} \rangle \rightarrow \text{others are 0, } m=0$$

$$= \frac{1}{2} m\hbar (2)(2-z)$$

$$? \quad \left(-\frac{2i\hbar}{\sqrt{2}} \right) \text{ (a)}$$

How could L_z be imaginary?

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \vec{L}^2 \rangle &= \hbar^2 \ell(\ell+1) Y_\ell^m \\ \langle \psi | \vec{L}^2 | \psi \rangle & \end{aligned} \quad \begin{aligned} \psi_{3,0} &: 2\hbar^2 \left(\frac{1}{2} \right) (1-z) \\ \psi_{2,1} &: 2\hbar^2 \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \right) (z-z^2) \\ \psi_{3,2,0} &: 6\hbar^2 \left(-\frac{1}{2} \right) \left(\frac{1}{2} z^2 - z + 1 \right) \end{aligned}$$

$$\hbar^2 + \frac{2i\hbar^2}{\sqrt{2}} - 3\hbar^2$$

$$= \hbar^2 \left(\frac{i}{\sqrt{2}} - 1 \right)$$

THE END